

Alex Collier

Design Engineer

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Profile

Design engineer working at the seam between design and frontend engineering. A decade shipping production interfaces, design systems, and AI product experiences, from token architecture and React component libraries to conversational and agentic LLM interfaces. Comfortable owning technical direction for design and translating it both ways, design intent into specifications and engineering constraints back into better product decisions.

Experience

Design Engineer

July 2026 to present

Volume7

- Work across design and frontend development, moving between Figma and production code on the same client projects
- Shipped frontend improvements to a live client product, resolving interaction defects and modernizing legacy UI
- Building new B2B credit limit review features, carrying flows from design through implementation
- Led discussions on how the team organizes design and development work as the org scales, covering handoff process and shared conventions

UX Engineer

May 2021 to May 2026

Keatext

- Owned product design and frontend direction for an AI analytics platform, serving as the bridge between design and engineering across the full product lifecycle
- Designed and shipped the interface for an agentic analysis product, including an LLM-driven report with custom data visualization and a conversational interface for interrogating results
- Redesigned the core experience for conversational AI where traditional UI patterns broke down, defining interaction models for streaming, uncertainty, and agent-initiated actions
- Converted a fragmented UI into a reusable component system built on design tokens, then maintained it as production React and TypeScript with accessibility and interaction fidelity as requirements, not polish
- Built token export and import tooling against the Figma API before the platform supported variables natively, keeping design and code in sync from a single source
- Established design-to-development workflows with product owners and engineers that cut handoff loops and made design decisions legible in code

UX/UI Design Lead

June 2017 to May 2021

Spartan Bioscience

- Built a design system from scratch, components, documentation, and Storybook, for medical device software in a regulated environment

- Designed and built high-fidelity prototypes and production interfaces for diagnostic software and training products
- Contributed design documentation to FDA 510(k) submissions and shipped HIPAA-compliant product surfaces
- Developed and maintained a customer support portal and corporate site with headless CMS integration
- Worked directly with engineering, management, and executive leadership to move design decisions forward

Marketing Coordinator

April 2015 to June 2017

Spartan Bioscience

- Contributed to UX and product design alongside the core team
- Managed the company WordPress site and server infrastructure

Projects

Portfolio assistant

acollier.ca

Conversational interface over the Gemini API, built in Nuxt and deployed on Netlify. Streams responses through serverless functions with abort signal propagation for cancelled requests, and routes cheap classification calls separately from generation. Prompt behaviour tested locally against open models with Ollama and LM Studio before shipping. Portfolio content lives in a separate private repository and gets injected at build time.

Education

Carleton University

Bachelor of Commerce, International Business & Marketing

Skills

- Design Systems
- Tokens & Component Architecture
- React
- Typescript/Javascript
- CSS
- Vue/Nuxt
- Figma
- Figma API
- Storybook
- Agentic and LLM Interface Design
- Conversational UI
- Prototyping
- Accessibility
- UX Design
- AI-assisted Workflows
- English (native)
- French